

What the future holds - the search for the ingredients of true intelligence

Mimicry is perhaps the sincerest form of flattery, but not the best. Our efforts to create robots that can truly match, if not exceed, human beings at the host of incredible processing and actuating abilities that we have are along a long path of understanding, technological and scientific progress, and perhaps even philosophical awakening.

As hardware evolves, robots will become more and more capable of accommodating high-density networks of sensors that can collude to collect never-before-seen volumes of data. Sensor technology itself is already



Source: <https://media.npr.org>

AI-based AlphaGo beat world champion Lee Sedol at the complicated game of Go - this is a huge step-up from chess, with a severalfold increase in the parameterspace.

burgeoning at breakneck speeds. We're not even sure what to do with new kinds of data such as that collected using electroencephalograms (EEGs) that record neuronal activity.

Data processing will evolve to derive efficient methods to cut out the junk and focus on what's useful - much like the human body knows that the ache of a hungry belly is to be prioritised over a sprained arm or a tired leg. Artificial intelligence will evolve to create learning modules that match the speed and breadth of human learning systems, and perhaps even eclipse them.

Maybe, in some dystopian, or even strangely utopian future - humans will have been outclassed, and rendered purposeless. **d**